

KIAN RAVAEI

**IPOD
VARIATIONS**

for flute, violin,
and electronics

(score)

ÆI edition

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ÆI edition

*Commissioned by Chamber Music Northwest
with the generous support of the CMNW Commissioning Fund.*

PROGRAM NOTE

In *iPod Variations*, I return to the music I loved as a teenager in an attempt to recreate my musical DNA. Like a shuffled playlist, each variation juxtaposes the musical styles of two different artists that were on my iPod, a technology that already evokes a previous era. It may seem unusual to pair Hendrix with Handel, or Bob Dylan with Deadmau5, but in my teenage years I didn't grasp the importance of historical context—it was all just music to me. Here, I put listeners in the same position through eclectic contrasts.

By adding to the flute and violin soloists an arsenal of recorded instruments—harpsichord, fretless bass, Hammond B-3 organ, Persian tār, and video game sound chips, to name a few—I tried to condense ten years of listening into roughly ten minutes of music, paying homage to guitar-shredding heroes (I, II, IV), jazz idols (III, V), and electronic music masters (II, VI). Like Bach's Goldberg Variations, the piece ends with a return to the opening aria—but now in an idealized rendering, as though seen through the lens of a nostalgic memory.

—Kian Ravaei

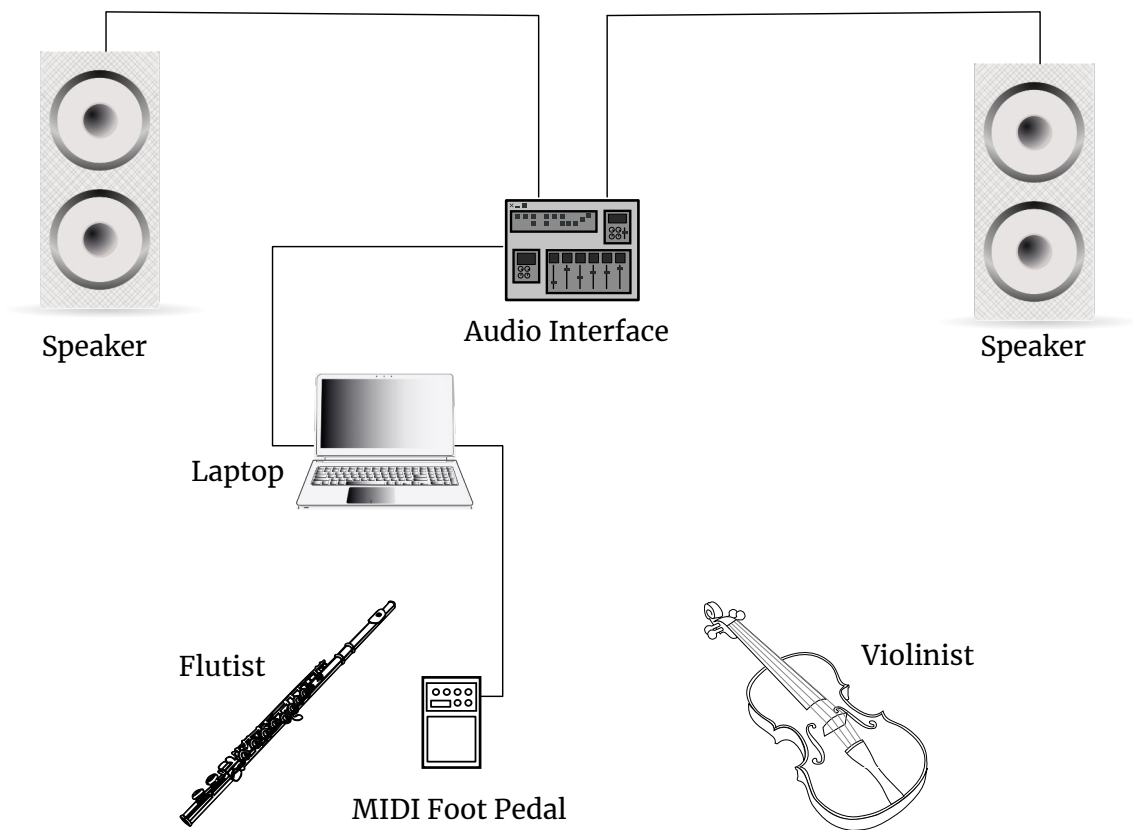
ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

My sincerest thanks to my musical mentors and collaborators past and present, whose contributions were essential in the creation of this work: Farzad Amoozegar, Fariborz Azizi, Valerie Coleman, Joe DiBlasi, Sooah Jeon, Alexi Kenney, Aaron Kohen, Tara Helen O'Connor, Thomas Mathias, Kenneth Renshaw, and Alex Sill.

duration ca. 12'

TECHNICAL INSTRUCTIONS

The electronics consist of sample playback triggered by the flutist's USB MIDI foot pedal. The following diagram shows the technical setup.



The laptop should have the free version of MaxMSP (cycling74.com) installed. Download the custom interface and audio files for *iPod Variations* at kianravaei.com/downloads/ipod-variations. Refer to the MaxMSP file for usage instructions.

SOFTWARE INTERFACE

Kian Ravaei

iPod Variations (2025)

updated 2025-04-30

Select MIDI Device

to Max 1 ▼

Setup:

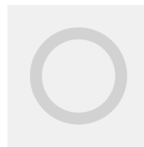
1. Make sure audio files are in the same folder as the Max file.

2. Select MIDI device using the dropdown.

3. In the Menu Bar, go to Options > Audio Status and select output device.

Cue #

GO



STOP



Navigate Cues:

- Arrow keys

- Click box, type number, and press enter

Play Cue:

- Spacebar

- Any MIDI input

Stop Cue:

- Escape key

PERFORMANCE NOTES

Upside-down triangles in the score and parts indicate the cue number and rhythmic position for pressing the foot pedal. Because of latency, the foot pedal may need to be pressed slightly before the indicated rhythmic position.

Performers should treat the electronics as an equal chamber music partner. Therefore, it is acceptable to have rhythmic flexibility when triggering the audio cues.

In both parts, page turns are provided on every page so that performers playing from iPads may turn pages with their finger if needed.

IPOD VARIATIONS

Aria
Sorrowful, with longing ♩ = 60

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[illegible][illegible][illegible]

33

p

p

36

mf

mf

8

f

f

40

f

f

9

ff

ff

10

43

11

12

electric guitar

7:6

3

harpsichord, continuo

Variation II (Kurt & Koji)

Grungy (same tempo) ♩ = 138

sing dissonantly while playing (lip bend)

47

11

12

13

ff quasi distorted guitar

drum kit

distorted electric guitar, bass guitar

ff quasi power chords

(lip bend)

51

13

14

15

(*ff*)

(*ff*)

54

14

3

3

57

15

mf

f

mf
chiptune synths

3

3

3

3

60

16

f

mf

f

3

3

3

3

63 $\text{♩} = 108$

fp *p* *f* *f*

17 18

f
guitar, bass, drums

66 $\text{♩} = 138$

ff *dirty* *mf*

19

chiptune synths

69

mf *f*

19

71 $\text{♩} = 108$

f *mf* *ff* *angsty*

19

♩ = 138

20

chiptune synths

f

guitar, bass, drums

The image shows a musical score for two parts. The top part, labeled 'chiptune synths', is written on a single staff with a treble clef. It begins with a '20' in a triangle, indicating a measure number. The notation includes various chords and single notes, with a '8va' marking above the final measure. The bottom part, labeled 'guitar, bass, drums', is written on a single staff with a bass clef. It starts with a dynamic marking '*f*' (forte). The notation consists of a few notes, including a half note and a quarter note.

♩ = 108

mf

$\text{♩} = 138$

81

ff

ff 22

mf 23

ff

chiptune synths

guitar noises, drums

8:7

Variation III (Jaco & Jimmy)
Grooving $\text{♩} = 108$

84

mf

mf

Hammond B-3 organ, fretless bass

mf

8:7

Soulful $\text{♩} = 72$

$\text{♩} = 108$

87

pp *freely, ethereal*

p *espr.*

24

90

Measures 90-91 of a musical score. The score is written for three staves: two treble staves and one bass staff. The key signature has two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The time signature is 4/4. The music features a complex melodic line in the upper staves with many accidentals and a more rhythmic bass line. Dynamic markings include *mf* (mezzo-forte) in both the upper and lower staves.

92

$\text{♩} = 72$

pp

p

poco

$\text{♩} = 108$

mf

mf

25

f

Measures 92-94 of a musical score. The score is written for three staves. Measure 92 has a tempo marking of $\text{♩} = 72$ and dynamic markings *pp* and *p*. Measures 93-94 have a tempo marking of $\text{♩} = 108$ and dynamic markings *mf* and *f*. The music includes triplets and a crescendo leading to a forte (f) dynamic. A rehearsal mark 25 is at the end of measure 94.

95

f mf

f mf

26

Measures 95-96 of a musical score. The score is written for three staves. Measure 95 has dynamic markings *f* and *mf*. Measure 96 has a rehearsal mark 26. The music continues with complex melodic lines and a crescendo.

97

f
p

99

$\text{♩} = 72$

ff
pp
mf
p leggero (non cresc.)

27

9

102

pp
pp

104

mf 5 *f luminous* *mf* 5

28

105

f luminous *p* *rit.* *p*

a tempo (freely)

106

p espr. *pp* *pp*

pp delicate

28

108 *rit.*

pp
delicate

tr *tr* *tr*

p espr.

pp

> pp

$\text{♩} = 108$

111

mf

mf

29

mf

f

113

f

f

$\text{♩} = 72$

pp
pale

pp pale

3

3

Variation IV (Lotfi & de Lucía)

116 Senza misura, improvisatory ♩ = ca. 69

Persian tār

mf

Flamenco guitar

tr

3

repeat gesture ad lib.,
gradually speeding up

117

p espr. *f > p* *f*

pizz. (quasi guitar strum)
strum speed follows dynamics (crescendo = speed up; diminuendo = slow down)

p *mf* *p* *mf* *p* *mf*

tr

3

118

p

p

30

f

6

p

[119]

First system of music, measures 119-120. The top staff (treble clef) features a melodic line with a slur over measures 119 and 120. Measure 119 contains a *p sub.* dynamic marking. Measure 120 contains a *f* dynamic marking. The bottom staff (bass clef) has a continuous tremolo pattern. Dynamic markings *mf* and *p* are shown with slurs across the bottom staff.

[119]

Second system of music, measures 119-120. The top staff (treble clef) features a melodic line with a slur over measures 119 and 120. Measure 119 contains a *ff* dynamic marking. Measure 120 contains a *p* dynamic marking. The bottom staff (bass clef) has a continuous tremolo pattern. Dynamic markings *p*, *mf*, and *p* are shown with slurs across the bottom staff. A measure rest is present in measure 120. A triangle with the number 31 is located below the bottom staff.

121

Third system of music, measures 121-122. The top staff (treble clef) features a melodic line with a slur over measures 121 and 122. Measure 121 contains a *p* dynamic marking. Measure 122 contains a *f* dynamic marking. The bottom staff (bass clef) has a continuous tremolo pattern. Dynamic markings *p*, *mf*, *p*, and *mf* are shown with slurs across the bottom staff.

[121]

First system of musical notation (measures 121-122). The score is written for three staves. The top staff (treble clef) contains a melodic line with a slur and a crescendo leading to a piano (*p*) dynamic. The middle staff (treble clef) contains a continuous tremolo. The bottom staff (bass clef) contains a melodic line with a slur and a crescendo leading to a piano (*p*) dynamic. A dynamic marking of *mf* is placed between the middle and bottom staves. A measure rest of 32 is indicated in the bottom staff.

[122]

Second system of musical notation (measures 121-122). The score is written for three staves. The top staff (treble clef) contains a melodic line with trills (*tr*) and a crescendo leading to a piano (*p*) dynamic, followed by a fortissimo (*f*) dynamic. The middle staff (treble clef) contains a continuous tremolo. The bottom staff (bass clef) contains a melodic line with a slur and a crescendo leading to a piano (*p*) dynamic, followed by a fortissimo (*f*) dynamic. A dynamic marking of *mf* is placed between the middle and bottom staves. A measure rest of 32 is indicated in the bottom staff.

[122]

Third system of musical notation (measures 121-122). The score is written for three staves. The top staff (treble clef) contains a melodic line with a slur and a crescendo leading to a piano (*p*) dynamic. The middle staff (treble clef) contains a continuous tremolo. The bottom staff (bass clef) contains a melodic line with a slur and a crescendo leading to a piano (*p*) dynamic. A dynamic marking of *mf* is placed between the middle and bottom staves. A measure rest of 32 is indicated in the bottom staff.

124

fp *p* *f* *f* *fp*

arco

repeat gesture ad lib.,
gradually speeding up

12 12

[125]

f *fp* *f* *f*

12 12 18

127

p *f* *p*

6 6 6 6 12 12

[128]

p *mf* *mf*

6 6 6 6 6 6

130

p

p

33

f *p*

pizz.

p

[131]

f *p* *f* *p* *f* *p*

mf

Variation V (Byrd & Basie)
Stylish ♩ = 108

132

f *p*

p *mf* *p*

34

35

choir

mf upright bass

jazz drums

3

136

mf arco *p* *p* (flz.) *fp* (trem.) *fp*

139

pp ghostlike sul tasto *pp* ghostlike

36

144

37

149

mf
p
mf

ord.

151

mf *f* *p* *f* *fp*
p *f* *fp*

38

154

mf *p* *mf*

157

mf dim...... *pp*

dim...... *pp*

160

mf cant.
off the string

pp leggerissimo

39 vintage horn section

164

f *mf cant.* *pp leggerissimo* *f* *fp*

167

mf *p* *pp* ghostlike sul tasto

40

3

Variation VI (Dylan & Deadmau5)

Driving ♩ = 112

173 rit.

ord. *f* quasi fiddle

41

f strummed acoustic guitar

tongue ram

177

sff *f* punchy *sff*

5

white noise

synth bass

strummed acoustic guitar

f

180 (tongue ram)

sff *f* *sff*

white noise

synth stab

synth bass

183

f *p sub.*

strummed acoustic guitar

f

186

f *a piacere*

189

p

42

synth pluck

white noise

mf

synth stab

synth bass

f punchy

sff

192

f

strummed acoustic guitar

f

194

f

5

sff

synth sounds

196

p sub.

p

strummed acoustic guitar

harmonica

198

espr.

200

43

strummed acoustic guitar

f

203 (tongue ram)

f

205

sf *f* *sf* *p* *f* *a piacere*

synth sounds

strummed acoustic guitar

208 molto rit.

p 44

harmonica

warm acoustic guitar

Aria da Capo

Nostalgic, warm ♩ = 52

212

p

pp

45 46 47 48

216

pp

p

p

pp

49 50

219 a tempo

pp

p

51 52 53

lap steel guitar

warm acoustic guitar

cello and bass section

222

54 55 56

soft piano, warm acoustic guitar

225

rit. a tempo

57 58 59

pp gently swaying

soft piano

warm acoustic guitar

pp

228

rit. al fine

60 61

pp

haze of instruments

